seeds with Indian varieties. Large-scale experimentations were undertaken in 1966–67 and the entire crop was saved as seeds. This scripted the 1967–68 success story.

India’s wheat production never looked back thereafter, increasing to more than 25 million tonnes in 1971–72 and reaching 50 million tonnes in 1988–89. India’s wheat production grew five times in twenty years since the terrible crisis of 1965–67. Wheat production had increased to 55.14 million tonnes in 1990–91 with an average yield of 2281 kg per hectares, which was more than three times the yield of 663 kg per hectares in 1950–51.

Foodgrains Production Took Off on the Back of the Wheat Revolution

Semi-dwarf varieties of rice came to India from the East. India introduced these high-yielding varieties on a large scale in 1968–69. The spread, though, was slower and less dramatic than wheat. Rice production of about 40 million tonnes in 1968–69 was not quite different than the production average recorded during 1963–65. But yields grew gradually and steadily thereafter. Rice production crossed 50 million tonnes in 1977–78 and 100 million tonnes in 2011–12.

Foodgrain production crossed 100 million tonnes in 1970–71 and 150 million tonnes in 1988–89. It was 171 million tonnes in 1990–91, having increased nearly three-and-a-half times from 50 million tonnes in 1950–51. Foodgrain yields, which were less than 700 kg per hectares in 1966–67, crossed 1000 kg per hectares for the first time in 1978–79 and had nearly doubled to 1380 in 1990–91.